

Daily Bible Note

Date: August 28, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 47:13-23

13 Thus says the Lord God: "These are the borders by which you shall divide the land as an inheritance among the twelve tribes of Israel. Joseph shall have two portions.

14 You shall inherit it equally with one another; for I raised My hand in an oath to give it to your fathers, and this land shall fall to you as your inheritance.

15 "This shall be the border of the land on the north: from the Great Sea, by the road to Hethlon, as one goes to Zedad,

16 Hamath, Berothah, Sibram (which is between the border of Damascus and the border of Hamath), to Hazar Hatticon (which is on the border of Hauran).

17 Thus the boundary shall be from the Sea to Hazar Enan, the border of Damascus; and as for the north, northward, it is the border of Hamath. This is the north side.

18 "On the east side you shall mark out the border from between Hauran and Damascus, and between Gilead and the land of Israel, along the Jordan, and along the eastern side of the sea. This is the east side.

19 "The south side, toward the South, shall be from Tamar to the waters of Meribah by Kadesh, along the brook to the Great Sea. This is the south side, toward the South.

20 "The west side shall be the Great Sea, from the southern boundary until one comes to a point opposite Hamath. This is the west side.

21 "Thus you shall divide this land among yourselves according to the tribes of Israel.

22 It shall be that you will divide it by lot as an inheritance for yourselves, and for the strangers who dwell among you and who bear children among you. They shall be to you as native-born among the children of Israel; they shall have an inheritance with you among the tribes of Israel.

23 And it shall be that in whatever tribe the stranger dwells, there you shall give him his inheritance," says the Lord God.

II. Key Summary

- God commands that the land be divided as an inheritance among the twelve tribes of Israel according to its borders, with two portions for Joseph; they are to inherit it equally, because God raised His hand in an oath to give it to their fathers.
 - The passage lists the four borders in order — north, east, south, west: from the Great Sea by the road to Hethlon toward Zedad; the Jordan on the east; from Tamar to the waters of Meribah by Kadesh along the brook on the south; and the Great Sea on the west.
 - When the land is divided by lot, the strangers who dwell among them and bear children among them are to receive a share as well; God commands that they be treated as native-born among the children of Israel and have an inheritance among the tribes.
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III. Passage Analysis

The land was promised on oath, so everyone's share is the same

“Equally with one another” literally reads “brother to brother, alike.” The land God promised and swore to give is received by all twelve tribes by the same measure. [1]

The land came from God's own oath to their fathers, so it was measured out by one standard — nobody got a larger share for performing better. What God gives has no tiers built into it.

The stranger is counted as family and shares the inheritance

The land God promised to Israel in this kingdom period would not be for Israelites alone. There would be people from other lands and ethnic groups (strangers) living there also. By God's command, these were to be treated as native-born among the children of Israel. They would even have inheritance rights. [2]

The older law asked Israel to treat foreigners kindly; here God writes them into the tribes and gives them land. God speaks first and counts the “guest” as family — that standing is given, not earned.

IV. Reflection Question

How much do you think a person has to do before they really belong to a group?

In this passage God tells Israel to give the resident strangers a share of the land and to regard them “as native-born among the children of Israel” — God is the one who counts them in first; the New Testament says it plainly: the Gentiles are “fellow heirs, of the same body, and partakers of His promise in Christ through the gospel” (Eph. 3:6).

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Website (ccbiblestudy.org), SDA Bible Commentary (notes on Ezekiel 47),

<https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT47.htm>

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik, <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/ezekiel-47/>